

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

NovaDesk User Guide

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1. Introduction

Welcome to the NovaDesk Enterprise Service Management Platform.

NovaDesk is a cloud-based service management application designed to help organizations manage customer support, internal IT service requests, asset management, knowledge management, and service-level agreements (SLAs) through a centralized platform.

This guide introduces the core features available to end users, service desk agents, team leads, and administrators.

The document explains how to access the application, navigate the interface, create and manage tickets, collaborate with teams, and use productivity features effectively.

Additional administrative features are documented separately in the **NovaDesk Administrator Guide (PROD-ND-ADM-002)**.

2. Product Overview

NovaDesk is designed to simplify service management by combining ticket management, workflow automation, reporting, and knowledge management within a single platform.

The platform supports organizations of all sizes, from small teams to enterprise environments with thousands of users.

NovaDesk follows IT Service Management (ITSM) best practices and provides configurable workflows to support incident management, service requests, problem management, and change management.

Major capabilities include:

- Service request management
- Incident tracking
- Asset inventory
- Knowledge base
- Workflow automation
- SLA monitoring
- Reporting and dashboards
- Role-based access control
- Notification management
- Audit logging

NovaDesk is accessible through modern web browsers and is optimized for desktop and tablet devices.

3. Key Features

Ticket Management

Create, assign, prioritize, update, and resolve customer or internal support tickets through a centralized interface.

Features include:

- Automatic ticket numbering
 - Priority management
 - Status tracking
 - File attachments
 - Internal notes
 - Customer communication history
 - Escalation workflows
-

Knowledge Base

Organizations can publish articles that help users resolve common issues without opening support tickets.

Knowledge articles support:

- Categories
 - Tags
 - Rich text formatting
 - Images
 - Attachments
 - Version history
-

Asset Management

Maintain an inventory of company assets including:

- Laptops
- Monitors
- Mobile devices
- Servers
- Software licenses
- Networking equipment

Each asset includes ownership, warranty information, maintenance history, and lifecycle status.

Workflow Automation

Administrators can automate repetitive tasks using configurable workflow rules.

Examples include:

- Automatic ticket assignment
- SLA reminders
- Email notifications
- Escalation rules
- Approval workflows

Automation helps reduce manual effort and improve response times.

Reporting

NovaDesk includes built-in dashboards for monitoring service performance.

Available reports include:

- Open tickets
- Closed tickets
- SLA compliance
- Average resolution time
- Agent productivity
- Customer satisfaction
- Asset utilization

Reports may be exported in PDF or CSV format.

4. System Requirements

To ensure optimal performance, users should access NovaDesk using supported operating systems and browsers.

Supported Operating Systems

Operating System	Minimum Version
Windows	Windows 10

Operating System	Minimum Version
macOS	macOS 12
Ubuntu	Ubuntu 22.04 LTS
Red Hat Enterprise Linux Version 9	

Hardware Requirements

Component	Minimum	Recommended
Processor	Dual Core	Quad Core
Memory	8 GB RAM	16 GB RAM
Storage	5 GB Free	20 GB Free
Display	1366×768	1920×1080

Network Requirements

Minimum internet bandwidth:

Activity	Minimum Speed
General Usage	10 Mbps
Video Attachments	25 Mbps
Administrator Tasks	50 Mbps

A stable broadband connection is recommended for uninterrupted access.

5. Supported Browsers

NovaDesk supports the latest stable versions of the following browsers.

Browser	Supported
Google Chrome	Yes
Microsoft Edge	Yes
Mozilla Firefox	Yes
Apple Safari	Yes

Internet Explorer is not supported.

Users should enable JavaScript and cookies for proper application functionality.

Pop-up blockers may interfere with certain administrative operations, including report downloads and file previews.

6. Logging In

Users receive login credentials from the IT Service Desk or Human Resources during onboarding.

Login Steps

1. Open the NovaDesk application URL provided by your organization.
2. Enter your corporate email address.
3. Enter your password.
4. Complete Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) if prompted.
5. Select **Sign In**.

After successful authentication, users are redirected to the Dashboard.

Password Requirements

Passwords must satisfy the following requirements:

- Minimum 12 characters
- At least one uppercase letter
- At least one lowercase letter
- At least one numeric digit
- At least one special character

Passwords expire every **90 days**.

The previous **five passwords** cannot be reused.

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

NovaDesk supports MFA using:

- Authenticator applications
- SMS verification
- Email verification
- Hardware security keys (administrator approval required)

MFA is mandatory for administrators and recommended for all users.

Forgot Password

If you cannot access your account:

1. Select **Forgot Password** on the login page.
2. Enter your registered corporate email address.
3. Verify your identity using the configured authentication method.
4. Create a new password that meets company password requirements.

If the account remains inaccessible after password reset, contact the IT Helpdesk.

Account Lockout

For security reasons, accounts are temporarily locked after **five consecutive unsuccessful login attempts**.

Locked accounts automatically unlock after **30 minutes** or may be unlocked earlier by the IT Service Desk after identity verification.

7. Dashboard Overview

The Dashboard provides a personalized summary of service desk activity immediately after login.

The information displayed depends on the user's assigned role.

Main Dashboard Components

Navigation Panel

Located on the left side of the screen.

Provides quick access to:

- Dashboard
- Tickets
- Knowledge Base
- Assets
- Reports
- Notifications

- Administration (authorized users only)
-

Search Bar

The global search bar allows users to search for:

- Ticket numbers
- Customers
- Assets
- Knowledge articles
- Employees
- Categories

Search results are displayed instantly as users type.

My Tickets

Displays tickets assigned to the logged-in user.

Each entry includes:

- Ticket Number
- Title
- Priority
- Current Status
- Due Date
- Assigned Team

Users may sort or filter tickets using multiple criteria.

SLA Summary

Displays the current SLA status of assigned tickets.

Metrics include:

- Tickets within SLA
- Tickets nearing SLA breach
- Tickets that have breached SLA
- Average response time

- Average resolution time
-

Notifications

The notification panel displays:

- Ticket assignments
- Status updates
- Mentions
- Approval requests
- Workflow alerts
- Maintenance announcements

Unread notifications are highlighted until acknowledged.

User Profile

The profile menu provides access to:

- Personal settings
 - Password management
 - Notification preferences
 - Language selection
 - Help Center
 - Sign Out
-

Dashboard Customization

Users may personalize their dashboard by:

- Rearranging dashboard widgets
- Selecting default landing pages
- Saving personal filters
- Changing dashboard themes
- Configuring notification preferences

Dashboard personalization affects only the current user's account and does not modify organizational settings.

Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	January 2024	Initial Product Release
2.0	January 2025	Added Asset Management Module
3.0	August 2025	Introduced Workflow Automation
3.2	January 2026	Updated Dashboard and MFA Features

8. Ticket Management

The Ticket Management module is the core component of NovaDesk. It enables employees, customers, and support teams to record, track, manage, and resolve incidents and service requests efficiently.

Each ticket receives a unique identifier that remains unchanged throughout its lifecycle.

Example:

INC-2026-00

0254

for incidents, or

SR-2026-001187

for service requests.

Ticket Types

NovaDesk supports multiple ticket categories.

Ticket Type	Description
Incident	Unexpected interruption or degradation of a service
Service Request	Request for access, software, hardware, or other services
Problem	Investigation into recurring incidents
Change Request	Planned modification to systems or services
Task	Internal operational work item

Selecting the correct ticket type helps ensure that the appropriate workflow, approval process, and Service Level Agreement (SLA) are applied.

Creating a Ticket

To create a new ticket:

1. Select **Tickets** from the navigation menu.
2. Click **New Ticket**.
3. Choose the appropriate ticket type.
4. Enter a concise title.
5. Provide a detailed description.
6. Select the affected service.
7. Choose the category and subcategory.
8. Set the priority.
9. Attach supporting files if necessary.
10. Click **Submit**.

Upon submission, NovaDesk generates a unique ticket number and sends a confirmation notification to the requester.

Ticket Fields

Each ticket contains the following information:

- Ticket Number
- Title
- Description
- Requester
- Assigned Agent
- Assignment Group
- Category
- Subcategory
- Priority
- Status
- Created Date
- Last Updated
- Due Date
- SLA Information

- Attachments
- Activity History

These fields provide a complete audit trail throughout the ticket lifecycle.

Ticket Priority

Priority determines the urgency and business impact of a ticket.

Priority	Description	Typical Response Time
P1 - Critical	Major business outage affecting multiple users	15 minutes
P2 - High	Significant functionality unavailable	1 hour
P3 - Medium	Limited impact with available workaround	4 hours
P4 - Low	Minor issue or informational request	1 business day

Support managers may adjust priorities when business conditions change.

Ticket Status

Every ticket progresses through predefined statuses.

Status	Meaning
New	Ticket has been created
Assigned	Ticket assigned to an agent
In Progress	Active investigation underway
Pending Customer	Waiting for customer response
Pending Vendor	Waiting for third-party action
Resolved	Solution provided
Closed	Ticket officially completed
Cancelled	Request withdrawn or invalid

Tickets automatically record timestamps whenever their status changes.

Ticket Assignment

NovaDesk supports both manual and automatic assignment.

Automatic assignment may consider:

- Team workload
- Skill matching
- Product expertise
- Business hours
- Region
- Service ownership

Managers may manually reassign tickets whenever operational requirements change.

Internal Notes vs Public Comments

Agents can communicate using two types of updates.

Public Comments

Visible to the requester.

Used for:

- Progress updates
- Resolution information
- Customer communication

Internal Notes

Visible only to authorized support staff.

Used for:

- Investigation details
- Diagnostic information
- Escalation discussions
- Vendor communication

Internal notes are never included in customer notifications.

File Attachments

Supported attachment formats include:

- PDF
- DOCX

- XLSX
- PNG
- JPG
- ZIP
- TXT

Maximum attachment size:

50 MB per file

Files exceeding the size limit are rejected during upload.

Ticket Resolution

Before resolving a ticket, agents should ensure that:

- Root cause has been identified.
- Solution has been documented.
- Required approvals have been obtained where applicable.
- Customer communication has been completed.

Resolved tickets remain available for reopening for **five calendar days** if the issue recurs.

9. Knowledge Base

The Knowledge Base enables organizations to publish reusable solutions that reduce repetitive support requests.

Employees can search articles before creating a new ticket.

Article Categories

Knowledge articles may belong to one or more categories.

Examples include:

- IT Support
- Human Resources
- Security
- Software Applications
- Hardware
- Policies

- Product Documentation
- Frequently Asked Questions

Proper categorization improves search accuracy.

Article Structure

Every article contains:

- Title
 - Summary
 - Detailed Content
 - Author
 - Category
 - Tags
 - Created Date
 - Last Updated
 - Version
 - Approval Status
-

Searching Articles

Users may search using:

- Keywords
- Product names
- Error messages
- Categories
- Tags
- Authors

Search results are ranked using relevance and popularity.

Article Ratings

Employees can provide feedback after reading an article.

Available ratings:

- Helpful
- Not Helpful

Users may also submit optional comments suggesting improvements.

Articles with consistently poor ratings are automatically flagged for review.

Article Versioning

NovaDesk maintains version history for every published article.

Each version records:

- Author
- Modification date
- Summary of changes
- Approval information

Previous versions remain accessible to administrators for auditing purposes.

10. Asset Management

The Asset Management module tracks hardware and software owned by the organization.

Each asset receives a unique Asset ID.

Example:

AST-000482

Asset Types

NovaDesk supports:

- Desktop Computers
- Laptops
- Monitors
- Mobile Phones
- Printers
- Servers
- Network Devices
- Software Licenses

- Cloud Resources

Additional asset categories may be configured by administrators.

Asset Information

Each asset record contains:

- Asset ID
- Asset Name
- Category
- Manufacturer
- Model
- Serial Number
- Purchase Date
- Warranty Expiry
- Assigned Employee
- Department
- Office Location
- Current Status

Asset Status

Available statuses include:

Status	Description
Available	Ready for assignment
Assigned	Currently allocated
Maintenance	Under repair
Reserved	Reserved for deployment
Retired	Permanently removed
Lost	Reported missing

Status changes are fully audited.

Asset Assignment

Assets may be assigned only by authorized administrators.

Before assignment:

- Employee identity must be verified.
- Asset condition should be confirmed.
- Warranty details should be recorded.

Employees receiving equipment must acknowledge receipt through the Employee Self-Service Portal.

Warranty Tracking

NovaDesk automatically monitors warranty expiration dates.

Notifications are generated:

- 90 days before expiry
- 30 days before expiry
- On the expiry date

These reminders help organizations schedule renewals and replacements proactively.

Asset Maintenance

Maintenance records include:

- Service Date
- Vendor
- Maintenance Type
- Cost
- Engineer
- Parts Replaced
- Completion Status

The maintenance history remains permanently associated with the asset.

11. Workflow Automation

NovaDesk includes a configurable workflow engine that automates repetitive operational tasks.

Automation improves consistency, reduces manual effort, and shortens response times.

Workflow Components

Each workflow consists of:

- Trigger
- Conditions
- Actions
- Notifications
- Approval Rules

Supported Triggers

Common workflow triggers include:

- Ticket Created
- Ticket Updated
- Priority Changed
- Status Changed
- Asset Assigned
- Knowledge Article Published
- SLA Threshold Reached

Administrators may configure additional triggers as required.

Supported Actions

Workflow actions include:

- Assign Ticket
- Send Email
- Create Task
- Escalate Ticket
- Update Status
- Notify Manager
- Notify Customer
- Add Internal Note

Multiple actions may be executed within a single workflow.

SLA Escalation Example

Example workflow:

Trigger

Ticket reaches 80% of SLA target.

Condition

Priority equals P1 or P2.

Actions

- Notify assigned engineer.
- Notify team lead.
- Notify service manager.
- Add escalation note.
- Send reminder email.

This proactive approach helps prevent SLA breaches.

Approval Workflows

NovaDesk supports configurable approvals for:

- Software installation
- Hardware requests
- Access requests
- Change requests
- Procurement requests

Approvers receive automated notifications and may approve or reject requests directly from the application.

Audit Trail

Every workflow execution is recorded.

Audit information includes:

- Workflow Name
- Trigger Time

- Executed Actions
- User
- System Response
- Success or Failure Status

Audit records cannot be modified by standard users.

Best Practices

NovaTech recommends the following:

- Search the Knowledge Base before creating a ticket.
- Keep ticket descriptions clear and detailed.
- Update ticket status promptly.
- Use internal notes for technical discussions.
- Close resolved tickets only after confirmation.
- Maintain accurate asset records.
- Review workflow rules regularly to ensure operational efficiency.

12. Reports and Analytics

NovaDesk provides comprehensive reporting capabilities that help managers, administrators, and executives monitor operational performance.

Reports are generated using real-time ticket, asset, workflow, and SLA data.

Authorized users can schedule reports for automatic generation and distribution.

Available Reports

The standard reporting module includes:

Report	Description
Open Tickets	Displays all active tickets
Closed Tickets	Summary of resolved tickets
SLA Compliance	SLA achievement statistics
Agent Performance	Productivity by support engineer
Customer Satisfaction	CSAT survey results

Asset Inventory	Current organizational assets
Asset Warranty	Warranty expiration tracking
Knowledge Base Usage	Most viewed articles
Workflow Execution	Automation statistics
Executive Dashboard	Organization-wide operational metrics

Reports may be filtered by:

- Date Range
- Department
- Product
- Priority
- Region
- Team
- Assigned Engineer

Report Export

Reports may be exported in the following formats:

- PDF
- CSV
- Microsoft Excel (.xlsx)

Scheduled reports can also be delivered through corporate email to authorized recipients.

Dashboard Widgets

Managers can customize dashboards using widgets such as:

- Open Tickets
- Critical Incidents
- SLA Breaches
- Average Resolution Time
- Customer Satisfaction
- Agent Workload
- Asset Summary

- Recently Published Knowledge Articles

Widgets refresh automatically every **5 minutes**.

13. Notifications

NovaDesk provides real-time notifications to keep users informed about important activities.

Notification Types

Notifications are generated for:

- Ticket Assignment
 - Ticket Updates
 - Status Changes
 - SLA Warnings
 - Approval Requests
 - Asset Assignment
 - Password Expiration
 - Knowledge Article Publication
 - Maintenance Announcements
-

Delivery Channels

Notifications may be delivered through:

- In-App Notifications
- Email
- Microsoft Teams Integration
- Mobile Push Notifications (if enabled)

Users may configure their preferred notification methods within personal settings.

Notification Preferences

Users can enable or disable notifications for:

- New Ticket Assignments
- Ticket Comments

- Approval Requests
- Workflow Events
- Scheduled Maintenance
- Security Alerts

Critical security notifications cannot be disabled.

14. User Settings

Every user has access to a personalized settings page.

Profile Settings

Users can update:

- Display Name
- Profile Photo
- Phone Number
- Time Zone
- Preferred Language
- Email Preferences

Changes to official employee information such as legal name or department require approval through the Human Resources system.

Password Management

Users may change passwords at any time.

Password requirements include:

- Minimum 12 characters
- Uppercase letter
- Lowercase letter
- Number
- Special character

Passwords expire every **90 days**.

The last **five passwords** cannot be reused.

Session Management

Users may:

- View active sessions
- Terminate other sessions
- Review login history
- Sign out of all devices

Sessions automatically expire after **30 minutes of inactivity**.

Theme Preferences

NovaDesk supports:

- Light Theme
- Dark Theme
- System Default

Theme preferences are stored within the user's account profile.

15. Keyboard Shortcuts

NovaDesk provides several keyboard shortcuts to improve productivity.

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl + N	Create New Ticket
Ctrl + F	Global Search
Ctrl + S	Save Current Form
Ctrl + K	Open Knowledge Base Search
Ctrl + /	Display Keyboard Shortcuts
Esc	Close Current Dialog
Ctrl + Shift + D	Open Dashboard

Keyboard shortcuts may vary slightly depending on browser and operating system.

16. Troubleshooting

The following table lists common issues and recommended resolutions.

Issue	Possible Cause	Recommended Resolution
Unable to log in	Incorrect credentials	Verify username and password or reset password
Slow application	Network latency	Verify internet connection and refresh the browser
Ticket not visible	Access permissions	Contact your administrator
Unable to upload attachment	File size exceeds limit	Reduce file size or split the file
Dashboard not loading	Browser cache	Clear browser cache and reload the application
Missing notifications	Notification preferences	Review notification settings and email filters

If the issue persists after following the recommended steps, contact the IT Service Desk.

Browser Troubleshooting

For optimal performance:

- Use a supported browser.
- Enable JavaScript.
- Enable cookies.
- Disable unsupported browser extensions if they interfere with application functionality.
- Keep the browser updated to the latest stable version.

Network Connectivity

If connectivity issues occur:

1. Verify internet access.
2. Restart the browser.
3. Connect through the corporate VPN if required.
4. Retry the operation.
5. Contact the Network Operations Team if the issue continues.

17. Security Best Practices

All users share responsibility for protecting NovaDesk and organizational information.

Employees should:

- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Lock their workstation when away.
- Keep passwords confidential.
- Report suspicious emails immediately.
- Verify links before opening them.
- Use company-approved devices.
- Install operating system updates promptly.
- Log out after using shared workstations.

Employees must never:

- Share passwords.
- Disable antivirus software.
- Install unauthorized applications.
- Store confidential company information on personal cloud storage services.
- Share screenshots containing sensitive customer information without authorization.

Suspected security incidents should be reported immediately to the Information Security Team.

18. Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. How do I create a new ticket?

Navigate to **Tickets**, select **New Ticket**, complete the required fields, and click **Submit**.

Q2. What is the maximum attachment size?

The maximum supported attachment size is **50 MB per file**.

Q3. Can I reopen a resolved ticket?

Yes. Resolved tickets may be reopened within **five calendar days** if the issue has not been fully resolved.

Q4. How often do dashboard widgets refresh?

Dashboard widgets automatically refresh every **five minutes**.

Q5. Can I customize my dashboard?

Yes. Users may rearrange widgets, save filters, and configure default dashboard layouts according to their preferences.

Q6. How do I search the Knowledge Base?

Use the global search bar or the Knowledge Base module. Articles may be searched by keywords, categories, tags, authors, or error messages.

Q7. When does my session expire?

Sessions automatically expire after **30 minutes of inactivity**.

Q8. Can I disable security notifications?

No. Critical security notifications remain enabled for all users.

Q9. What browsers are officially supported?

NovaDesk supports the latest stable versions of Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Mozilla Firefox, and Apple Safari.

Q10. Who should I contact if I cannot resolve a technical issue?

Contact the IT Service Desk or your system administrator with details of the issue, including screenshots and error messages where applicable.

Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	January 2024	Initial Product Release
2.0	January 2025	Added Reporting Module
3.0	August 2025	Introduced Workflow Automation
3.1	October 2025	Added Notification Preferences
3.2	January 2026	Updated Security Best Practices and Troubleshooting

Related Documentation

For additional information, refer to:

- NovaDesk Administrator Guide (PROD-ND-ADM-002)
- NovaDesk API Integration Guide (TECH-API-001)
- Information Security Policy (COMP-SEC-003)
- Employee Handbook (HR-EMP-001)